



Faculty of Information Technology

FIT5125 / FIT4005

IT Research and Innovation Methods

Assignment 1: Part 1

Semester 2, 2025

Scope

Tasks related to material in Weeks 1-6.

Value

This assignment is worth **5%** of the total marks for **Assignment 1**.

Assignment due date

Task 1, 2 and 3: **Thursday, 21 August 2025 at 11:55 PM (Australian Eastern Time)**

Task 4 and 5: **End of Week 6 (depending on your booking)**

Submission method

You must complete the activities for *Part 1 of Assignment 1 (5% of the marks)* in order to be in a position to complete *Part 2 of Assignment 1 (95% of the marks)*.

Part 2 will be released on Moodle at 11:55 PM on Friday, 5 September 2025 (end of Week 6).

For these preparatory activities, you are required to:

- Submit a single Google Form (Task 1);
- Book your participation in a Kluster Event (Task 2) and Complete a consent (Task 3)
- Participate in a 45-minute video-conferencing event in Week 5 or 6 (Task 4), and finish a Qualtrix Survey after participating in the event (Task 5).

Use of Artificial Intelligence

This is an **authentic assessment**, that is, the work assessed relies to a significant extent on your participation in, and reflection on, a real-world study for which you will play the role of both a subject (in weeks 4, 5 and 6) and a researcher (in weeks 7 and 8). For this reason, there are **no restrictions** on your use of **Artificial Intelligence** to complete this assignment, and you are not required to provide any details of its use (should you choose to use it).

Special Consideration

Monash policy on Special Consideration is available at:

<https://www.monash.edu/exams/changes/special-consideration>

What is the rationale? To complete *Assignment 1*, you are required to take part in a study of a novel online video collaboration tool called *Kluster* (see *Figure 1*), as both a subject (*Part 1*, during weeks 4, 5 and 6) and as a researcher (*Part 2*, during weeks 7 and 8). In this way, over the course of the assignment, you will gain first-hand experience of being engaged in a real-world IT research and innovation project.

- **Being the subject:** In *Part 1* of *Assignment 1* (Week 4-6), you play the role of a subject in the study for which you will be required to: (i) complete a consent form; (ii) create a profile (for your future Kluster account); (iii) taking part in a live Kluster networking event with 40 other students and do a survey (to capture demographic and other information including your user experience and preferred style of communication).
- **Being the researcher:** In *Part 2* of *Assignment 1* (Week 7-8) in the study requires you to: (i) consider how the ethical consideration of study may need to change for other settings; (ii) find research literature relevant to Kluster's design and evaluation; and (iii) conduct an interview with a subject of a Kluster networking event (i.e. another student) to understand their experience of this new platform.

Is this actually Research? Yes, it is, and the PhD researcher who has planned and is running the study (Rheinanda Kaniawari) would like to use students' data (anonymised) to inform her research on video collaboration. All students have the option to either consent or not consent to this. The markers will not know whether you agreed to have your data used for this purpose.

Do I have to do this? Whether you consent to having your data used or not, you still have to do all the activities, which culminate in Week 5 or Week 6, with your participation in a 45-minute online collaborative video event (using Kluster). Because the majority (95%) of the marks for the assignment are for Part 2, and Part 2 requires you to understand what Kluster is, it is crucial that you complete all the tasks described below.

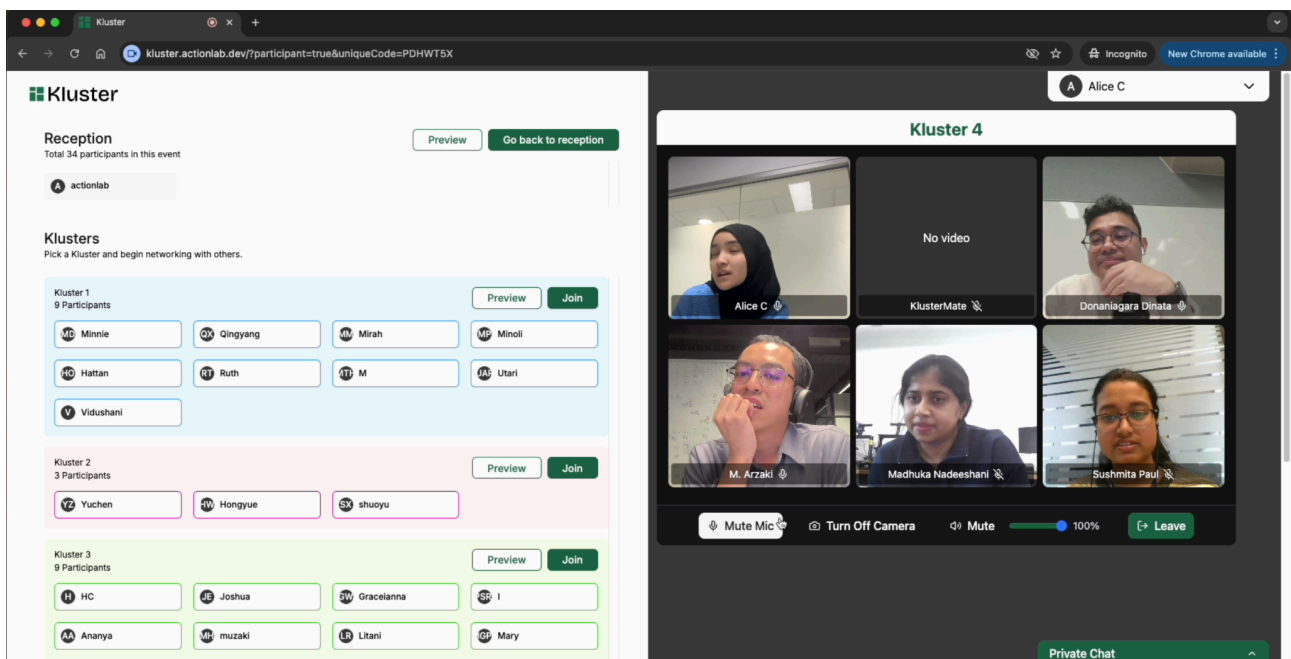


Figure 1. A screenshot from a Kluster event.

Task 1: Create content for your Kluster profile (estimated time 15 mins)

Deadline: **Thursday, 20 August 2025 at 11:55 PM (Australian Eastern Time)**

When you take part in your Kluster event, you will be set the task of finding the names of possible team members for an activity for Assignment 2. The team that you will be assigned to for this activity will be drawn (in part) from the names of those students that you meet during the Kluster activity (you'll be asked to propose a list of 10 students). The activity will require members with a range of skills, including people with diverse language skills (i.e. not just English), technical skills, and graphic design skills. To help with this, you should create a Kluster profile for yourself that will include: (i) *Full name*; (ii) *Nickname* (10 characters max); (iii) *Email* (your university email); (iv) *Study program*; and (v) *Skills and interests* (240 characters max).

For this task, we ask you to submit a first draft of your content for these fields in advance, using this [Google Form](#).

Task 2: Book your participation in a Kluster event (estimated time 5 mins)

Deadline: **Thursday, 20 August 2025 at 11:55 PM (Australian Eastern Time)**

For the assignment, you must take part (as a subject of the study) in a Kluster event. These remote events require you to have access to a laptop or desktop with an internet connection and a camera (it's a video conference event after all!). Each workday in Week 5 and Week 6, three Kluster events (40 participants maximum) are scheduled to take place at 5 PM, 6 PM and 7 PM (Australia Eastern Time). You can book your attendance at one of these events using this [Calendly link](#).

Task 3: Complete the study consent form (estimated time 10 mins)

Deadline: **Thursday, 20 August 2025 at 11:55 PM (Australian Eastern Time)**

Whether or not you decide to allow your data to be used by PhD student Rheinanda Kanaswari, you are required to read the "Explanatory Statement" for the study and indicate your consent (or not) using this [Qualtrics survey link](#). Make sure you indicate all of the "No" checkboxes if you decide that you do not allow your data to be used for the research.

Task 4: Participate in your Kluster event (estimated time 45-60 mins)

Deadline: **End of Week 6 (depending on your booking)**

After completing the first three tasks—creating your Kluster profile (Task 1), booking your Kluster event (Task 2), and filling out the consent form (Task 3) — the final steps are: attend your Kluster event, connect with people you'd like on your Assignment 2 team, and then complete the after-event survey (Tasks 4 and 5). Be sure to arrive in good time (a few minutes early), and have your Kluster profile text close at hand, as you will need to enter this into Kluster at the beginning of the event. **You must use Google Chrome to access Kluster, and you must turn off any ad blockers, as the system will not work properly otherwise.**

Task 5: Complete your study participant survey (estimated time 20-30 mins)

Deadline: **After you participate in the Kluster event.**

The study requires you to complete a survey that captures demographic information as well as other data, such as your user experience and communication style preferences. You should aim to do this right after you attend your Kluster event. The survey link **will be emailed to you** once you have **completed the consent form** (Task 3).